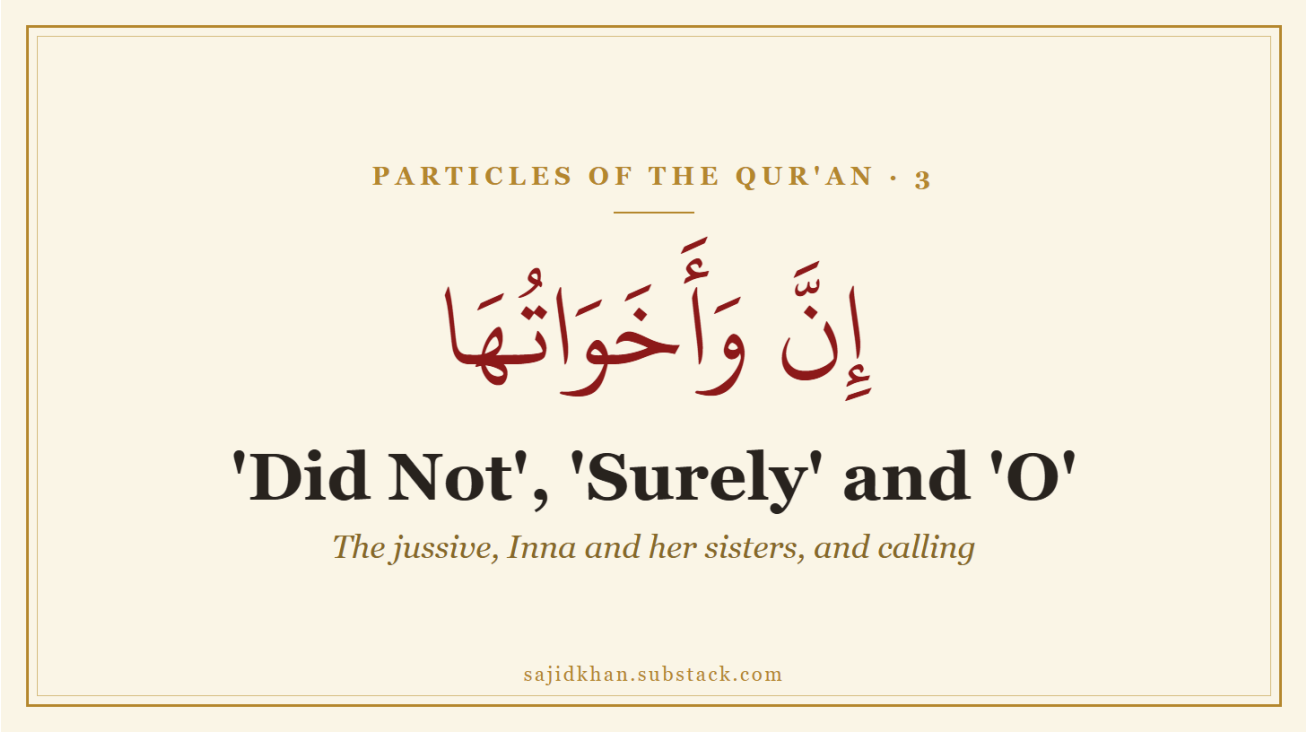


PARTICLES OF THE QUR'AN

Particles of the Qur'an 3: 'Did Not', 'Surely' and 'O'

The jussive particles, Inna and her sisters, and the particles of calling

Particles of the Qur'an, part 3 of 5

Five particles that make a verb jussive

The jussive (*jazm*, جَزْم) is the mood where the verb ends in sukun: يَنْصُرُ "he helps" becomes يَنْصُرْ. If the verb ends in ن, as in تُبْدُونَ "you show", the ن drops: تُبْدُوا. These five particles cause it. The first four examples use the verb نَصَرَ "to help".

1. **if:** إِنْ (*in*), the particle of condition. إِن تُبْدُوا الصَّدَقَاتِ فَنِعِمَّا هِيَ "If you give charity openly, that is good" (2:271).
2. **did not:** لَمْ (*lam*). It turns a present verb into a past denial: لَمْ يَنْصُرْ "he did not help".
3. **not yet:** لَمَّا (*lammaa*). لَمَّا يَنْصُرْ "he has not helped yet" (but he still may).
4. **let him:** the لِ of command (*laam al-amr*, لَامُ الْأَمْرِ). لِيَنْصُرْ "let him help, he should help".
5. **do not:** the لَا of forbidding (*laa an-nahy*, لَا النَّهْيِ). لَا تَنْصُرْ "do not help".

Inna and her sisters

Six particles come before a nominal sentence. They make its subject accusative (fatha) and leave the predicate nominative (damma). They are called "the particles resembling a verb" (*al-huroof al-mushabbahah bil-fi'l*, الْحُرُوفُ الْمُشَبَّهَةُ بِالْفِعْلِ), or simply *inna wa akhawaatuhaa* (إِنَّ وَأَخَوَاتُهَا, "inna and her sisters").

1. **surely:** إِنَّ (*inna*). إِنَّ اللَّهَ مَعَ الصَّابِرِينَ "Surely Allah is with the patient" (2:153). اللَّهَ takes fatha.
2. **that (surely):** أَنَّ (*anna*). أَشْهَدُ أَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ "I bear witness that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah" (from the call to prayer).
3. **as if, like:** كَأَنَّ (*ka-anna*). كَأَنَّهُنَّ الْيَاقُوتُ وَالْمَرْجَانُ "as if they were rubies and coral" (55:58).
4. **but:** لَكِنَّ (*laakinna*). وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ "but most people do not know" (7:187).
5. **if only, I wish:** لَيْتَ (*layta*). يَا لَيْتَنِي كُنتُ تُرَابًا "Oh, I wish I were dust!" (78:40).
6. **perhaps, so that:** لَعَلَّ (*la'alla*). لَعَلَّكُمْ تُفْلِحُونَ "so that you may succeed" (2:189).

The particles of calling

The particles of calling (*huroof an-nidaa'*, حُرُوفُ النِّدَاءِ) are used to address someone: يَا "O", أَيَا "O", هَيَا "O (someone far)", أَيْ "O (someone near)", and أَ "O (someone very near)". By far the most common in the Qur'an is يَا "O".

- **Accusative:** when the one called is the first noun of a possessive pair, it takes fatha. يَا أَهْلَ الْكِتَابِ "O People of the Book" (3:64).
- **Damma, fixed:** a single name takes damma, and it does not change. يَا نُوحُ "O Noah" (11:32).

Two more

- **No ... at all:** لَا that denies a whole kind (*laa an-naafiyah lil-jins*, لَا النَّافِيَةُ لِلْجِنْسِ) makes its noun accusative. لَا رَيْبَ فِيهِ "there is no doubt at all in it" (2:2).
- **Is not:** مَا and لَا with the meaning of لَيْسَ "is not" make the predicate accusative. مَا هَذَا بَشَرًا "this is not a human being" (12:31).

Next: particles that change nothing at all.

From my book Quran Grammar Summary *(second edition), section 1.5.*

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